

THE LIFE & TIMES OF LED ZEPPELIN



Robin Morris

The Led Zeppelin Story...



Plant & Page Releasing...

The Sixties...

What really amazes one is that the music industry in London back in the sixties was actually fairly small. Just about everybody who played a guitar or musical instrument, knew everybody, played with each other at one time or another or went to school or art school together...

Kind of like if you played in a band and you were a student at the Art School, you were automatically part of the whole groove, which to us as kids growing up in SA, the British music ensemble resembled this massive bowl of infinitely talented Brits that literally took the music world by storm, meanwhile it was really just a handful of dedicated young exceptionally talented kids all eager to get out of the British working class and try and make it as Musos and they did it. Just about all of them became rich and famous and they were still in their early twenties.

There's Jeff Beck and Jimmy Page growing up together, swapping licks and hanging out at Brian Jones' place because he had the best blues records and could play just about any instrument, with George Harrison as a regular weekend visitor.

Bands like – 'The Kinks', 'Eric Burdon & The Animals', 'The Small Faces', 'Fleetwood Mack', 'The Who', 'Cream with Eric Clapton' plus even the more musically elevated groups like, 'Jethro Tull' and 'The Moody Blues' and of course

'The Rolling Stones' and the indomitable 'Beatles' to name just a few, were all pretty close friends. They were also devout fans of the USA blues greats, often copying licks from their cotton picking hero's from across the pond.

When Zeppelin got together they were late in the game. Jimmy Page and John Paul Jones were reputable session musicians, earning good coin while the above bands were paying their dues, doing club work and releasing the occasional record. By the time Zeppelin had become the biggest band in the world, after the release of their fourth album, a lot of the above bands had already played out but Zeppelin were never alone. Other similar major contemporaries at this stage were Brit hard rockers like: Black Sabbath; Deep Purple and Uriah Heep, all huge success stories and all blazing mesmeric music trails across the world's many stages.

Little did the musically erudite Page know at the ripe old age of a mere twenty two years old, what the future held, when he was still an avid session musician earning his daily keep with his beloved Les Paul.

As a session musician, Page claims to have featured on around 50% of all the songs coming out of Britain at the time, including Joe Cocker's version of 'With A Little Help From My Friends' with that distinctly scintillating guitar sound that only Page can generate...

In the beginning...



Beck in the centre with Page on the extreme right

When Clapton left 'The Yardbirds' he was replaced by the formidable Jeff Beck. Later, a position came up for a new bass player. Jeff asked his old mate Jimmy Page if he wouldn't mind stepping in to help out until they'd found a solid bass player. Jimmy agreed. Then the second guitarist left and Jimmy was again asked to help out as they'd found a bass player. Jimmy moved up to second guitar behind Beck. It didn't last long. Beck soon left to start his own band, 'The Jeff Beck Group'. Jimmy took over the number one guitar spot and completed a successful tour of the USA with 'The Yardbirds.' The band then dismantled even though they had a few

hit records (For Your Love...) that were doing well in the USA.

Page was determined though to create a band like no other. He already had a head full of songs and was a huge talent as a guitar player, easily comparable to Jeff Beck. With close friend and fellow session musician, John Paul on bass, he began his search for a singer. The Yardbirds' manager, big burly Peter Grant, agreed to join Page as manager for his new band.



Peter Grant

Page desperately wanted Paul Rodgers who had recently left 'Free' as his lead singer (he claimed Rodgers was the best in the UK) but Rodgers declined, as did Rod Stewart, who had joined Jeff Beck as lead singer for the 'Jeff Beck Group'. Their debut single 'Hi Ho Silver Lining' went gold as did their debut album 'Truth'.

Ironically, Page got his way many years later, forming a band with Paul Rodgers as lead singer, in a band called 'The Firm'. They released a few albums but the band disintegrated as they had all 'been there and done it' and none of them were really interested in touring, etc., anymore...

Page then asked his mate 'Steve Marriott' from the Small Faces to join his new band but he also declined, as did several other leading rock singers. One can only imagine a year later how these same rock singers must have kicked themselves (very hard...!) for turning Page down.

Page was by now getting frantic until he heard about this long blond curly haired, tall, lean mean machine with a voice like fire and brimstone from Birmingham. Peter Grant and Page immediately drove up to Birmingham and interviewed a relatively unknown young Robert Plant.

Plant hesitantly agreed to join Page's new band provided he could bring his drummer mate, John Bonham. Page agreed after seeing Bonham & Plant do a set with their current band at a club in Birmingham. Bonham's thunderous style of drumming fitted in perfectly with what Page had in mind for his new band.

Plant and Bonham went to London and stayed with Page. At the time they were both totally in awe of the superior axe wielding skills of Jimmy Page who was

already a highly acclaimed musician in London music circles, due to his session work and his career with 'The Yardbirds'.

Peter Grant organised a jam in downtown London in a basement room. From the word 'go' the vibe was electric. They jammed a few old 12 bar blues numbers. It was so explosive, they all immediately knew they had found gold. Page said the vibe was so intense there was enough energy to light up a city. He couldn't believe the power Bonzo exerted from his drums. It gave Zeppelin their unique high energy sound for the future. Page built most of his songs around that powerhouse sound using Bonham's authority and Jones' fluid bass to create the inimitable Zeppelin rhythm foundation.

Much later on in Bonzo's career, he did a large part of his 'Moby Dick' solo with his bare hands.

Tough guy...!

When Hendrix heard Bonzo play in London with Zeppelin he offered to buy Bonzo from Page.

The new band played several UK venues and then did a tour of the USA, releasing 'Zeppelin One', their debut album. It was huge. People were literally blown away by the massive sound; Plant's soaring vocals, Page's dynamic guitar, John Paul's legerdemain on bass as well as keyboards, mandolin and several other instruments and John Bonham's explosive drumming. No other band came close to what they were doing. Page's dream had suddenly arrived and it all accelerated very quickly thereafter.

The second US tour was followed by the release of 'Zeppelin Two' with the iconic 'Whole Lotta Love'. The album went gold almost worldwide. Zeppelin became rich and famous overnight.

While in the US the band met Crosby, Stills, Nash & Young. Page and Plant were overly impressed by their harmonies and complex chord progressions. CSNY's '4 Way Street' double album had a huge affect on the 'Zeppelin Three' album, which Page and Plant put together while stuck away in a little derelict stone house somewhere up in the highlands in Wales.

Off stage, Page pursued the dark side as a devoted fan of Aleister Crowley and his occultist black magic mysticism. He also adopted a fetish for whips and handcuffs for his many groupies. Page was the only single member of the band. The other three were all married with children.

A notable interest was how big an influence Dylan and especially 'The Band' with their 'Big Pink' album had on Zeppelin. In fact Dylan seemed to have an influence on every muso (including Hendrix who was obsessed with Dylan) in

London at the time. After Dylan's release of 'John Wesley Hardin', which features Dylan on the cover sporting a beard, the four Zeppelin's all grew beards. It seems like whatever Dylan said or did the Brit muso's followed to the letter with even John Lennon taking to wearing the famous Dylan cap (like Andy Cap) after the 'fab four' met him.



Bob 'Blowing In The Wind' Dylan

Clapton, after hearing the 'Big Pink' album, flew to Woodstock and asked 'The Band' if he could join them. They declined and asked him to rather get stoned with them. From this he managed to trade a few licks with his guitar hero, 'Robbie Robertson'. Clapton returned to London and boasted to Page and Plant. It was like a Schoolboy victory.

Interestingly enough, in Dylan's biography book, 'Chronicles' Dylan talks about how excited he'd get when he had the makings of some new songs and he'd then rush over to where CSNY stayed and play the new songs to the guys to get a reaction...!

It certainly elevates CSNY...

Bowie's early album, 'Hunky Dory' (still a personal favourite) also influenced Page but possibly more because Page claimed 'Hunky Dory' was peppered with Satanic influences.

Page had Crowley quotes inscribed on the Zeppelin albums somewhere on the vinyl towards the centre...mean mother...!

One of Page's favourite early albums was Van Morrison's 'Astral Weeks'. His influences as a guitarist are mostly 'Moorish' and Kashmir' with Eastern scales.

Page is described by his fellow musicians as brilliant but an even bigger rip off artist than his druggie mate, the infamous 'Keef'. Many of the now famous Page licks (including Whole Lotta Love) were ripped off from some other artist. In some cases Plant never even changed the lyrics, or ever so slightly. Because everyone knew each other, no-one was sued and when they were (like for Whole Lotta Love) it was always settled out of court by a very intimidating Peter Grant.

At least with the Stones, Mick always wrote his own licks...



Their Satanic Majesties Request

The Stones also dabbled in the dark side following Page with his Occult obsession, especially with their blatant release of 'Sympathy For The Devil' and their very controversial and disgusting 'Goats Head Soup' album (apparently the goat is greatly revered by Satanists for sacrificial purposes), followed by an even more blatant, 'Their Satanic Majesties Request'.

John Paul Jones, the quiet one and the glue of the band, fondly talks about the time when he was still a young session musician, he found a young protégé called 'Davey Jones' (no relation to JP) that he took 'under his wing' and showed him the rudiments of music. He says the youngster was extremely good looking with an abundance of talent and an above average grasp of music, which he very quickly and easily took to levels way beyond. Of course the young Davey Jones turned out to be one 'David Bowie'.



The Enigmatic Bowie...

John Pauls' influence on Zeppelin's sound was huge. As a multi-instrumentalist, he provided all the keyboards and weird sounds behind Jimmy's

demonic guitar, Plant's towering vocals and Bonzo's loud and very full percussion whilst still providing a full bass line from his feet on bass pedals when he wasn't thumping out a strong walking bass on his beloved Fender Jazz bass.

Having toured the USA a lot it was inevitable that Zeppelin would get to meet fellow muso's from 'across the pond'. Jim Morrison and Alice Cooper plus many other twisted Neanderthals crossed Zeppelin's path. Page was fascinated by the depth of the satanic level of the Americans. The Brits were somewhat tame in comparison. This was a trend that had yet to engulf the staid English hippy culture back home but that was all about to change.



The Sex Pistols Doing It Their Way...

Once again, ironically, as the seventies progressed, it was the Brits who produced, 'The Clash' and the 'Sex Pistols' (amongst others) with the notorious 'Johnny Rotten' and one 'Sid Vicious'.

Zeppelin got to meet Johnny Rotten and it had a profound effect on Page. The band were waiting to go on stage when none other than Johnny Rotten himself bumped into them, called them a bunch of faggots and a lot more before being herded away by security. For the first time Page looked at their image and music, which was so out of line with the new punk revolution.

Zeppelin also got to meet Janis Joplin. It was at an outdoor festival somewhere in the USA. Janis always had her own caravan at these events so she invited the four Zeppelin members to her caravan for a drink. She produced a few bottles of Tequila (which was her favourite medicine) and taught them how to drink Tequila with salt and lemon. A little later all four Zeppelin members were horizontal. Plant says his knees just turned to rubber. Even Bonzo, who was famous for his capacity to indulge in copious amounts of alcohol was no match for Janis and her Tequilas.



The original Tequila Sheila...!

Janis panicked a little. She suddenly realised she had the biggest band in the world lying comatose in her caravan from a few bottles of Tequila. She got hold of Peter Grant who sorted it out but he made a point of telling everyone back home across the pond that the four wankers had been drunk under the table by a woman...!

One must understand that back then there was no internet; no cell phones; limited TV, no 24/7 TV with multiple channel choices like you have today; no play station; and you had all these young guys in their early twenties, bursting with testosterone and energy and they were all filthy rich and famous with ego's stretching out beyond the Universe.

Shit had to happen...

Zeppelin's long time childhood hero, Elvis invited them to Graceland. The Zeppelin members were beside themselves with joy. Page in particular asked Peter Grant to request if his idol guitarist, 'Scotty Moore' (Elvis' guitarist) could also be there. Unfortunately for Page only the King was resident to receive them. They spent two wonderful hours with Elvis discussing life on the road, groupies, the new Punk rock revolution (which Elvis despised), promoters, venues and music in general. When they left, Elvis asked them for their autographs, which he said was for his six year old daughter, Lisa. Plant phoned home and told his wife...'it doesn't get any bigger – they'd met Elvis and he asked for their autographs...!'

The third Zeppelin album sells the least amount of albums. Although still substantial for a hard rock album it pales in comparison to Zeppelin One and Two. Page even introduces a completely acoustic set into their live performances to cater for the acoustic songs on the three albums. This gives John Paul the opportunity to dazzle Zeppelin fans with his dexterity on his three neck guitar, which incorporates a mandolin for the one neck.

Disappointed about the sales of the third album, the band clock back into the

studio. The press and especially the Christian groups, still target Jimmy for his occult dealings even though their contemporaries like 'Uriah Heep' go blatantly public with their dark side by releasing albums like 'Demons & Wizards' followed by 'The Magician's Birthday', both of which go gold.

Jimmy begins putting together material for the fourth Zeppelin album, which includes their benchmark rock song, 'Stairway To Heaven' as well as other notables like: 'The Battle Of Evermore', the catchy acoustic, 'Going To California' and the resilient, 'When The Levee Breaks'. The band retires to 'Headley Grange', a remote Victorian house in East Hampshire that Jimmy loves because of its dark and morbid history of witchcraft, rituals and such crap.

Financially, the band is now very secure. With annual proceeds from the three albums plus merchandising and touring profits (their asking price for appearance fees is now upwards of \$100,000.00), the band clears more money than even they can hope to spend. This however all pales in comparison after the launch of their fourth album.

1970 has come and gone. A lot's happened in the rock industry. The 27 club has taken its toll with Hendrix, Jones, Joplin, Morrison, Dennis Wilson (Beach Boys) and others. Later, Keith Moon and even Presley, all succumbed to drug OD's or similar. Punk music's on the increase. Disco, headlined by the Bee Gees, goes huge with movies featuring John Travolta, etc. Rock music is on the way out. Page realises he has to come up with something spectacular if Zeppelin are going to stay in the game.



The Definitive Fourth Album...

It is said that many spells were cast to formulate the fourth album. Jimmy refused to have any lettering/copy or name on the cover other than a picture of 'The Hermit' from the Tarot cards plus four demonic logos, one for each Zeppelin member. Plant, being the eternal hippy and a 'Lord Of The Rings' fanatic wasn't

pleased about it but went with it.

Plant had by now earned his status in the band. He was no longer the shy young boy (Plant was the youngest in the band), totally in awe of the older Page and John Paul, like he was when he initially joined the band. Plant had now emerged as a 'Rock God', as quoted by 'Rolling Stone' magazine, mobbed by adoring fans wherever he went. This of course lifted his status and his ego way beyond his wildest expectations. He still felt like a 'country boy' but certainly acted the part of a super star even though everyone in the know, knew the band was still essentially 'Jimmy's' band.

When it came to writing the lyrics for 'Stairway...' Plant says he was sitting next to Page who was strumming through the chord progression for 'Stairway' on his acoustic. Plant had a pencil and paper in hand and was noodling along when he suddenly started writing, *'There's a lady who says all that glitters is gold and she's riding a stairway to heaven...'* When he realised what was happening he'd already written a few verses, which he quickly read to Jimmy. Jimmy was ecstatic, immediately naming the song, 'Stairway To Heaven'. The next day they sat down together and once again Plant says he mysteriously completed the remainder of the verses. He continues to say that funny enough none of the words changed later on, which would normally happen once he got to tighten up a song with Page.

A parallel thing also happened when he wrote 'Thank You' on Zeppelin Two and 'Tangerine' on Zeppelin Three, both similar evocative songs like 'Stairway'. Whether this actually happened or not we'll never know but Plant was the least interested in the occult out of all of them...

The album was also released after a world tour, which wasn't the norm as the band normally released an album and then committed to a world tour to promote the album but in this instance Jimmy just knew he had an album that was so good, so great, so intense and so majestic that he decided to do a world tour first and treat Zeppelin fans to the music before releasing the album.

The album, finally released in 1971, went on to sell 32 million copies in the USA alone with over 50 million copies sold worldwide in the first year. Jimmy refused to allow the record company to release 'Stairway...' as a single, forcing fans to purchase the album in order to access the song.

Financially, this put Zeppelin into the mega wealth category where for Zeppelin and Peter Grant, money now lost all its shine. They had become the biggest band in the world, knocking the 'Rolling Stones' off their throne. Accolades and awards flooded in from all over the world.

Zeppelin no longer shared tours with other bands as they now commanded

sell out tours of 100,000 to 150,000 fans at a time so they purchased a jet airliner, naming it, 'The Starship', which they used for touring. The jetliner was pimped to the max with even a huge Hammond organ for Jones and a double bed for the groupies. A large Zeppelin logo emblazoned on both sides of the plane let everyone know whenever they were in town.



Plant & Page Going Gold...

On one occasion on landing at LA's airport the pilot parked next to Hugh Hefner's 'Playboy' jetliner. As they were disembarking a 20 foot limo pulled up and out leapt a string of scantily dressed playmates and boarded the Playboy plane. Bonzo, ever the optimist, broke rank and tried to board the plane with the playmates but was told by two beefy bodyguards to get lost. When he explained that he was from the jetliner next door and he was Bonzo of Led Zeppelin, the bodyguards informed him that they didn't give a shit who he was, he wasn't boarding the plane. It was humbling for the Zeppelin members who realised they may have been Kings in the world of Rock but they still had a way to go on centre stage compared to the real players in the world.

After the release of the fourth album the band's popularity increased ten-fold as did their earnings but with fame and fortune also comes the leveller. The band member's egos had ejaculated into the stratosphere. They'd become 'untouchable' as Hendrix once described them, but the inevitable cracks in the armour slowly became visible.

Their follow-up album, 'Houses Of The Holy' failed to sell anywhere near what the fourth album sold and the press of course had a field day, which is only fair considering what the press had to put up with from Peter Grant's mad ravings over the years, so when the press were able to hit back, they did so with all guns blazing...

Bonzo pulls a gun on Deep Purple's bass guitarist and threatens to shoot his fugging head off because he dated Bonzo's wife while still at school...WTF...!

Bonzo goes even more crazy while on tour, teaming up with his best buddy while in LA, the infamous Keith Moon (The Who) who was just as insane. The two of them continually try to outdo each other as to who can be the worst nightmare, culminating in both 'The Who' and 'Zeppelin' being banned from most hotels, resulting in the Zeppelin members tending to try and distance themselves from Bonzo, staying in hotels as far away as possible, which creates rumours and certainly ignites the spiral that Zeppelin were about to take.

Page meanwhile, slips even further into the dark side, fuelled by his new heroin and coke habit, which Bonzo and Peter Grant have also adopted.

'Physical Graffiti' a double album, is launched and well received, selling well globally but fails to have the life span of the first four albums that all still feature prominently in the top 100 album sales in the USA.

Page is asked to do the soundtrack for Kenneth Anger's new movie, 'Lucifer Rising' which Page eagerly accepts. Two years later it backfires on him terribly when the movie flops and Anger publically blames Page for the 'pathetic' soundtrack. Page's answer is to become a recluse, seldom venturing out except to stock up on more heroin. He's described by Peter Grant as an obscenely thin 'stick insect', ghostly white in appearance and constantly hiding behind 'midnight' spectacles.

Robert Plant becomes the most famous face and body in the world of rock. His sex appeal with female fans, due to his tight fitting jeans (sans underwear), earns him the title of 'Rocket In The Pocket'. Apparently according to the Zeppelin members - Plant is extremely well hung...! Initially, female fans affectionately called Plant, 'Little Hitler' because they could see his 'German Helmet' but this was replaced by the US press who labelled him, 'The Blond Rock God' because Plant was famed for telling young girls that he would 'give them every inch of his love...!' which he no doubt did...

To add to the Zeppelin woes, Plant has a bad car accident (with his family), which takes him off the road for two years while he learns to walk again. During this time he reflects on why he should carry on with Zeppelin as they really have nothing left to prove, the music isn't going anywhere. Bonzo and Jimmy have serious heroin habits. Jones also wants to resign from the band. All three members want to spend more time with their respective families who they'd seriously neglected over the preceding years due to all the touring.

Page is horrified when he learns of Plant's and Jones' desires. It forcefully kicks him out of his recluse. He introduces plans for yet another world tour, which

once again is put on hold when Plant's six year old son 'Karac' dies of a respiratory disease. It is the end of Plant. He wants out, blaming Jimmy for all his demonic dealings...

World tours for Zeppelin had by now become monumental affairs with laser lights, revolving stages, multiple platforms, pyrotechnics and so on plus they could only play in the largest world arenas and even then there were riots as thousands of fans gate crashed fences, people got hurt, some even died. Zeppelin's equipment alone almost needed its own Jumbo jet, considering Jones had a grand piano, Hammond organ, assorted keyboard racks, ARP synthesisers, mellotron, etc., plus racks of Marshall double stack amps, gigantic PA systems, tiered speakers and so on.

The final tour of 1978 is no exception. Plant and Jones are back, agreeing to one more tour but the tour is marred with disaster right from the beginning when Peter Grant beats up a security guard and is arrested. The riots get even bigger at every event of the world tour as mayhem ensues. The music is overshadowed by the massive deluge of damage, costing millions, which is left in their wake. The world press have another field day. The four Zeppelin members are left feeling very disillusioned. What had started out as being four brilliant musicians, eager to sell their brand of music to the world stage, has turned into a nightmare of hypnotic drugs, Satanism, death and destruction, wherever they now went...

As the punk revolution sets in, Zeppelin meets 'The Police'. They are very impressed by the three youngster's dexterity on their instruments and their music. At the Melody Maker awards, Zeppelin are crowned as the band of the year. Bonzo, when receiving his award, once again lets the side down, claiming over the mic that the award should have rather gone to 'The Police' and promptly sings a few verses of 'Message In A Bottle' much to the delight of the crowd of music officials, celebrities and who's who in the music industry.



Zeppelin Rocking Knebworth...

Zeppelin are offered a million quid (the highest sum ever paid) to perform for two nights at the annual Knebworth concert which they agree to. The event is held over two consecutive weekends with Zeppelin doing the evening Saturday night spot. The first concert is a sell out but the second concert only attracts around 40,000 fans.

The fact that the weather was typical English slosh with horrendous downpours is probably the reason but the band read it as a sign that their popularity is definitely on the wane. It's never happened to them before. They decide on a radical change and model themselves on their favourite new band 'The Police'. Out go the outrageous dragon sequined costumes and flared bell bottoms to be replaced by tight trousers and open neck shirts with skinny low slung ties. They even cut their hair. The large arenas, laser lights and so on are all disbanded in favour of small venues where they can once again get in touch with their audiences. Songs like 'Dazed & Confused' with the bow sequence and 'Moby Dick' with Bonzo's drum solo are all dropped. Even the long guitar solos are out.

It's a disaster. The press make a huge issue of their new image to try and look young but with the haircuts they only appear to look their age and are described as 'desperate old men' plus the smaller venues create even bigger riots as fans are denied tickets. In addition, devout Zeppelin fans are unhappy. They want to see Zeppelin in all their glory - not a watered down version.

Page slips back into his recluse mode as his heroin habit deepens. Plant finally takes over the leadership of the band and uses John Paul's musical genius to put together the next album, 'In Through The Out Door' which follows up from the dismal 'Presence' album. Jimmy plays some of his best guitar on the album but the music takes a completely new direction with a lot of synthesiser and effects. Gone are the long guitar solos and steep driving guitar riffs. Unfortunately, it is to be their final album...

Bonzo, only 32 years old, sadly passes away in 1980 after a drinking bout.

It happened at Page's new 900,000 quid mansion in Sussex that he purchased from actor, Michael Caine. Apparently, Bonzo passed out drunk (what's new..?) on a bed and never woke up the following day. When John Paul went to wake him, he was inert. It is the end of Zeppelin. Peter Grant calls in the press and tells them the band is officially disbanding as they can no longer continue without Bonzo.

Plant and Jones are actually relieved it's all finally over.

It is the end of an incredible era...

After a two year or so mourning period, Plant releases his long awaited solo album,

which does extremely well. He releases a second album which does even better. Page cleans up his habit and guests with various artists as does John Paul.

Over the next thirty years the three original members get together on special occasions and perform a few songs together, sometimes using Jason Bonham (Bonzo's son) on drums but other than the famous O2 concert they would never get together seriously and tour as Led Zeppelin ever again as Plant is adamant it will never happen. He even refuses to sing 'Stairway To Heaven', something which deeply saddens Page. Plant has become the Numero Uno in what is left of the band with the remaining members walking around on egg shells in his presence.

Page tries in vain to find a replacement for Plant even trying out Aerosmith's 'Steven Tyler'. Tyler arrives in London for his audition but tells Page the Zeppelin stuff is all old and they should rather try some of his new music he'd written. Page promptly sends him packing on the next available plane out of Heathrow back to the USA...

Page teams up with a few vocalists, notably Paul Rodgers (The Firm) and even David Coverdale (Whitesnake) but nothing lasting happens. Plant has become irreplaceable for the distraught Page. He does an acoustic mini tour with Plant concentrating more on Eastern music and influences but this also sadly eventually fizzles. Plant is determined to pursue only his new successful solo career.

Peter Grant has a heart attack and dies in 1995.

Plant is extremely successful, releasing ten solo albums. He teams up with the sassy bluegrass country singer, Allison Krauss. Their 'Raising Sands' album goes platinum (2008) and wins five Grammy awards at the 51st Grammy Awards in 2009...



The Unplugged Plant & Krauss...

Footnote: It makes one feel rather inadequate when you consider what these guys experienced and did in life and contributed in music. Just one of them did more by the time they were thirty, compared to what a lot of us achieved collectively, at the age of sixty! The remaining Zeppelin members are now (2012) all in their sixties...

Led Zeppelin Orchestral CD:



To commemorate the Life and Times of Led Zeppelin and their incredible music, the author has produced an instrumental tribute album featuring fifteen of their greatest songs, created in full orchestration, capturing all the Big Band sounds including soaring wind instruments, deep melodic strings and tight, resonating rhythms.

To listen to MP3 snippets of the songs, log onto: www.robinmorris.co.za

Click on: CD & DVD's

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To really experience this Orchestral album you need to listen to the CD on a good stereo where you'll hear each philharmonic instrument in full clarity. Sixteen multi-tracks went into the recording of this historic album...

The complete album is available to purchase from:

cdbaby on: <http://cdbaby.com/cd/robinmorris4>

or from the following:

Create Space: Robin Morris – Instrumental Orchestral Tribute To Led Zeppelin

Amazon: Robin Morris – Instrumental Orchestral Tribute To Led Zeppelin

If you live in South Africa you can order direct by e-mail on: assegai99@gmail.com



Further Reading...

Books:

Backstage Passes, Life on the wild side with David Bowie by Angie Bowie

Dazed & Confused by Chris Welch

Life by Kieth Richards & James Fox

In The Houses Of The Holy by Susan Fast

Jeff Beck – Crazy Fingers by Annette Carson

Jimmy Page – An Unauthorised Biography by George Case

Led Zeppelin 1V by Erik Davis

Jimi Hendrix – The Man The Magic The Truth by Sharon Lawrence

Led Zeppelin – The Definitive Biography by Ritchie Yorke

When Giants Walked The Earth by Mick Wall

Peter Grant by Chris Welch

Chronicles – Bob Dylan by Bob Dylan

Stairway To Heaven by Richard Cole

Stoned by Andrew Loog Oldham

The Guitar Greats by Stuart Grundy & John Tobler

The Hurdy Gurdy Man by Donovan

Dylan On Dylan by Jonathan Cott

The Yardbirds by Alan Clayson

Truth – Rod Stewart/Ronnie Wood by Dave Thompson

Eric Clapton – The Autobiography by Eric Clapton